MO TOWN COMPLETE GEOGRAPHY & HOUSING

OVERALL LAYOUT:

Mo Town is a mid-sized city with five distinct boroughs, each reflecting overarching emotional/thematic states. The Motions and Exacerbators live and work across these boroughs based on their circumstances, families, and roles. Before Capital, these boroughs were connected by community, shared spaces, and the central Community Center. After Capital, they become more isolated, separated by the casino's influence.

The Aesthetic: Everything has a teal tint - buildings, streets, sky, lighting. Before Capital: bright, clear teal. After Capital: darker teal with neon orange/gold corruption from the casino.

THE FIVE BOROUGHS OF MO TOWN:

1. THE HEART (Central Borough)

Overarching Theme: Connection, Community, Gathering, Pulse of the City

What It Represents: The emotional center of Mo Town - where people come together, where community happens, where the city breathes.

Key Areas:

The Historic District (DESTROYED - Now Casino District)

- **Location:** Dead center of The Heart borough
- **What It Was:**
  - The Community Center (warm teal stone, big windows, open courtyard with fountain - the literal and metaphorical heart)
  - Community gardens where people grew food together
  - Public art installations including Shade's early graffiti work
  - Small local businesses owned by Mo Town residents
  - Open plaza with benches where people gathered to talk, eat lunch, meet friends
  - Tree-lined streets with wide sidewalks
  - Accessible gathering spaces for all ages and abilities

    - Weekly farmers markets, community dinners, festivals
    - The fountain in the courtyard where people made wishes, had first conversations, found peace
- **What Replaced It - The Gilt:**
    - Massive imposing structure dominating the skyline
    - Neon orange and gold lights corrupting the teal (visible from all boroughs)
    - Glass and chrome exterior, reflective surfaces everywhere (Mirrorball's influence)
    - Multiple floors:
        - **Ground Floor:** Main gaming floor - slot machines, card tables, roulette wheels
        - **Second Floor:** Additional gaming, sports betting areas
        - **Third Floor:** Restaurants, bars (overpriced, designed to keep people inside)
        - **Fourth Floor:** Entertainment venues, performance halls (where Mirrorball performs)
        - **Fifth Floor:** VIP lounges (where Velour operates), exclusive access, luxury comfort
        - **Sixth Floor:** Honeytrap's private suite (highest tier VIP, by invitation only)
        - **Top Floor:** Capital's hidden office (appears as mirrored wall, one-way glass overlooking entire casino)
        - **Basement/Underground:** IT infrastructure, server rooms, security hub (Glitch's domain), employee areas
    - Parking lots paved over the community gardens (concrete where greenery was)
    - "Luxury" condos built quickly around casino (expensive, soulless, empty units bought as investments)
    - Casino-branded businesses (gift shop, pawn shop, convenience store)
    - Security checkpoints, cameras everywhere (Bossy Boots' surveillance)
    - Remnants of the old fountain visible in one corner, broken and dry, surrounded by slot machines
    - The DJ booth (elevated, central, visible) where Amp cranks the volume

Downtown Core

- **Location:** Surrounding The Gilt, radiating outward
- **Still intact but changed:**
    - Mixed-use buildings (3-5 stories, shops below, apartments above)
    - Local businesses struggling (some closed, replaced by chains)
    - Corporate franchises moving in (casino money)
    - Professional offices
    - Mo News - glass-front building, newsroom visible from street, The Broadcast Building
    - Analytics Central Data Center - modern building, servers, climate controlled
    - Plenty & Sons Construction Co. - storefront/office with supply access
    - Union Terminal - central transit hub connecting all five boroughs
    - Coffee shops, restaurants (some still local, some chain)
    - Banks, financial services
    - Casino advertising everywhere (billboards, posters, digital screens)
- **Before Capital:** Bustling but community-oriented, local shops where owners knew customers by name, people shopping and chatting, stopping to talk on sidewalks, supporting each other's businesses

- **After Capital:** Corporate chains, transactional interactions, casino advertising overwhelming, people rushing and avoiding eye contact, local businesses closing

Meridian Park (What's Left)

- **Location:** Public green space that survived casino construction (on the periphery of The Heart)
- **Features:**
  - Open green space with mature trees
  - The Bandshell - outdoor performance pavilion with amphitheater seating
  - The Movement Studio - where Flo teaches dance classes (building in the park)
  - Flowing water features, curved paths
  - Sound system for performances
  - Mirrors and barres for outdoor practice
  - Benches, picnic areas
  - Community squares where Plenty used to host community dinners (now rarely happens)
  - Farmers market still operates (smaller, less frequent)
  - Public seating, gathering spots
  - People still try to gather, but it's not the same
- **Before Capital:** Free dance classes, community performances, potlucks, festivals, always something happening, always people together
- **After Capital:** Fewer events, casino wants Flo to perform at The Gilt instead, less funding for free programs, spaces feel emptier

Housing in The Heart:

Residents:

- **Plenty**
  - Loft apartment above Plenty & Sons Construction Co. office/storefront in downtown
  - Open floor plan, exposed brick and beams
  - Big kitchen (where he loves to cook)
  - Warm, welcoming, photos everywhere (of Pilot and Pinch, family memories)
  - Comfortable furniture, lived-in
  - Workshop space for small projects
  - Where Pilot and Pinch visit on weekends/custody time
- **Ledger**
  - Apartment near Analytics Central Data Center in downtown core
  - 1-bedroom (affordable but nice enough)
  - Organized but lived-in
  - Multiple monitors for work-from-home
  - Small but efficient kitchen
  - Carries the weight of supporting Signal financially
- **Signal**
  - Lives with or very near Ledger (she helps support him)
  - If separate: small studio near Mo News
  - If with Ledger: takes the living room/pullout couch
  - Journalism materials everywhere, notebooks, recording equipment
  - Always researching, always working

- **Honeytrap**
  - Luxury penthouse in high-rise near The Gilt
  - Top floor, exclusive building
  - Floor-to-ceiling windows overlooking the casino
  - Expensive, tasteful, seductive décor
  - Red and gold accents against the teal
  - Multiple rooms for "entertaining" and private meetings
  - Everything designed to impress and ensnare
  - Wine collection, art (status symbols)
  - Walk-in closets, spa bathroom
  - Rooftop access (private terrace)
- **Velour**
  - Luxury condo in same building as Honeytrap (one floor below)
  - Still expensive, still exclusive
  - Indulgent, plush, comfortable to excess
  - Velvet furniture, soft lighting, thick carpets
  - Almost too comfortable - you sink in and don't want to leave
  - Lavender and cream tones against the teal
  - Multiple seating areas, all luxurious
  - Bedroom like a cloud
  - Follows her sister's lead even in housing choice
- **Mirrorball**
  - Flashy loft in downtown (visible, prominent location)
  - All mirrors, reflective surfaces, glass everywhere
  - Everything for show - looks amazing from the outside
  - Floor-to-ceiling windows (always visible)
  - Inside is hollow, performative
  - Expensive furniture but no personal touches
  - Just aesthetic, no soul
  - Lights always on, always "on stage"
  - Even when alone, performing

The Vibe:

- **Before Capital:** The pulse of Mo Town, always alive with people gathering, community events daily, farmers markets twice weekly, street festivals monthly, the heartbeat of the city, circulation flowing, everyone connected
- **After Capital:** Corrupted center, The Gilt looming and dominating, the heart is sick and struggling, people avoid downtown now (too painful, too changed), circulation disrupted and irregular, the pulse is weak and irregular, community gatherings rare

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2. THE HEIGHTS (Northwest Borough)

Overarching Theme: Elevation, Clarity, Perspective, Aspiration, Control

What It Represents: The part of Mo Town that's literally and figuratively higher - where you can see clearly, where structure and order exist, where those who seek control or peace reside, where wealth and poverty coexist on different levels.

Key Areas:

The Summit (Highest Point)

- **Location:** Absolute peak of The Heights, above even the Mo Town sign
- **The Mo Town Sign:**
    - Large letters on the hillside (like Hollywood sign)
    - Teal letters, iconic landmark
    - Visible from all boroughs
    - Used to represent hope, pride in the city
    - Now Capital's mansion looms above it (symbolic dominance)
- **Capital's Cliffside Mansion:**
    - Modern architectural masterpiece
    - Cantilever design with supports extending over the cliff edge
    - Glass walls facing the city (can see all five boroughs)
    - Concrete and steel, modern, cold aesthetic
    - Gray, chrome, teal-tinted glass
    - Minimal landscaping, just stone and structure
    - **Interior:**
        - Open floor plan, soaring ceilings
        - Minimal furniture (doesn't need comfort)
        - One perfect chair facing the windows
        - Panoramic views of entire Mo Town spread below
        - Can see The Gilt, all five boroughs, everything
        - Wine cellar (expensive collection)
        - Study (where he plans)
        - Bedroom (barely used, doesn't sleep much)
        - Kitchen (pristine, rarely used)
    - **Completely alone** - no staff, no visitors, no family, solitary
    - Private gated road leading up
    - Security system (not Bossy Boots - maintains separation)
    - Intentionally isolated and inaccessible

Hillcrest (Residential Hills)

- **Location:** Hillside below The Summit, elevated terrain with views
- **Characteristics:**
    - Homes built on slopes, terraced lots
    - Can see across Mo Town (but not as high as Capital)
    - Mix of income levels but all elevated (cheaper as you go down the hill)
    - Rooftop gardens, terraces, balconies with views
    - Clearer air than lower boroughs, less congested
    - Tree-lined streets on slopes, winding roads
    - Staircases connecting different levels
    - Hillside parks with overlooks

Overlook District (Professional Quarter)

- **Location:** Flattest part of The Heights, planned development
- **Characteristics:**
    - Apex Architecture & Design (Polish's firm) - sleek glass building

    - Modern glass buildings, clean lines
    - Precision Health Associates (Frame's medical office) - organized healthcare facility
    - Professional offices, corporate buildings
    - Clean, angular, minimalist aesthetic
    - Perfect landscaping (manicured, controlled)
    - Wide boulevards, street parking
    - Feels exclusive, expensive
    - Corporate lunch spots, high-end coffee

Streamside (Peaceful Edge)

- **Location:** Where The Heights meets Clearwater Creek, northwest edge
- **Characteristics:**
    - Older buildings (2-3 stories, historic charm)
    - Quieter streets, less traffic
    - Clearwater Creek runs through neighborhood
    - Spiritual/esoteric vibe (Harbor's influence)
    - Tranquil Tides Esoteric Shop (Harbor's store)
    - Gardens, meditation spaces, greenery
    - Small bridges over the creek
    - Mix of residential and small businesses
    - More affordable than Overlook District
    - Community feel despite being in The Heights
    - Tree-canopied streets
    - Birdsong, flowing water

Housing in The Heights:

Residents:

- **Capital**
    - Cliffside mansion above Mo Town sign (as described above)
    - Lives completely alone
    - Overlooks everything, separated from everything
- **Harbor, North, and Bossy Boots**
    - Multi-generational home in Streamside near Clearwater Creek
    - 3-level home (Tranquil Tides Esoteric Shop on ground floor or nearby)
    - Harbor's aesthetic dominates: peaceful, plants, crystals, incense, warm colors
    - North's room: huge windows overlooking the city, organized but lived-in, special interests visible
    - Bossy Boots' room: structured, minimal, security system she installed, stark contrast to rest of house
    - Shared spaces: kitchen where Harbor makes tea, living room with meditation corner, rooftop meditation space
    - Garden in back with creek access
    - Feels like a sanctuary despite Bossy Boots' presence
- **Polish**
    - Penthouse in Overlook District
    - Modern high-rise, top floor
    - Floor-to-ceiling windows, city views

    - Immaculate, cold, minimalist
    - Everything white, teal, and gray
    - Perfect furniture that looks uncomfortable
    - Kitchen that's too clean (barely used)
    - Pilot's room: controlled but has some toys (Polish tries to organize them)
    - Pinch's room: very neat, organized (she's afraid to mess it up)
    - No warmth, beautiful but unlived-in feeling
    - Polish's office at home (works constantly)
    - Where Pilot and Pinch live during the week
- **Frame**
    - Structured townhome in Overlook District
    - Everything compartmentalized, organized
    - Each room has a specific purpose, no overlap
    - Home office (perfectly organized, filing system)
    - Living room (formal, rarely used)
    - Kitchen (organized by system, labeled containers)
    - Bedroom (minimal, functional)
    - Cubicle aesthetic even at home
    - Clinical, clean, sterile
    - Feels like an extension of Precision Health Associates
- **Drift**
    - Small apartment in Hillcrest (lower part, cheaper area)
    - Can barely afford it, stretches her budget
    - 1-bedroom, older building
    - Messy, scattered, half-unpacked boxes
    - Doesn't quite fit in The Heights
    - Bills piling up, reminders everywhere
    - Feels too small and too expensive
    - Can see The Heights neighborhoods she can't afford
    - Works at Precision Health Associates but can't live in Overlook District

The Vibe:

- **Before Capital:** Aspirational but accessible, clarity and perspective available to all, peaceful overlooks, structured but not oppressive, community on the hills
- **After Capital:** The Gilt is visible from every vantage point (can't escape seeing it, neon pollutes the views), Polish works even longer hours, pressure intensifies, wealth gap widens (rich getting richer, Drift barely hanging on), some areas become exclusive and expensive (pushing out long-time residents)

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3. THE LOWER WARDS (East/Southeast Borough)

Overarching Theme: Movement, Chaos, Overwhelm, Survival, Noise

What It Represents: The working-class, busy, dense part of Mo Town - where life is chaotic, where people are just trying to survive, where the noise never stops, where community used to thrive but now everyone's isolated in the scramble.

Key Areas:

Ironside (High-Density Residential)

- **Location:** Eastern residential core, densest part of Mo Town
- **Name Origin:** Named for the old iron fire escapes zigzagging down every building
- **Characteristics:**
    - Apartment buildings (3-5 stories, pre-war construction)
    - Narrow streets with cars parked on both sides
    - Iron fire escapes zigzagging down buildings (the defining feature)
    - Laundry hanging from windows and balconies
    - Small corner stores (bodegas, convenience stores)
    - 24-hour shops, laundromats
    - Fast food, cheap eats
    - Little green space, mostly concrete
    - Playgrounds (small, fenced, worn equipment)
    - Urban density, people living close together
    - Thin walls, hear your neighbors
    - Affordable but cramped
    - Mix of families, single people, immigrants
    - Multi-generational living common

The Crossroads (Commercial/Transit Chaos)

- **Location:** Commercial heart of Lower Wards, always moving
- **Characteristics:**
    - Delivery routes crisscrossing everything (hence the name)
    - Loading zones, trucks double-parked
    - Traffic constantly, honking, chaos
    - Transit hub, bus stations, transfers
    - Markets with overwhelming options
    - Vendors calling out, competing for attention
    - Samples, sales, noise
    - Everyone rushing, no time to stop
    - Pedestrians weaving through traffic
    - Never quiet, even at night
    - Neon signs, competing advertisements
    - Street food vendors, smells mixing
    - Guess wanders here constantly, paralyzed by choices

Warehouse Row (Light Industrial)

- **Location:** Southern edge of Lower Wards, transitioning to industrial
- **Characteristics:**
    - Warehouses lined up in rows (hence the name)
    - Supply yards, loading docks
    - Distribution centers
    - Where goods come in and go out
    - Working-class jobs (warehouse, delivery, manufacturing)
    - Mix of storage and small manufacturing
    - Truck traffic, forklifts

    - Chain-link fences, concrete
    - Some small factories still operating
    - Shift workers coming and going at all hours

Housing in The Lower Wards:

Residents:

- **Quake and Static**
    - Family apartment in Ironside
    - 2-bedroom in older building (3rd floor walk-up)
    - Small but lived-in, a little cluttered
    - Quake's delivery route maps on the wall
    - Static's school papers scattered around
    - Kitchen table where they eat together
    - Plants (half alive - Quake tries)
    - Comfortable furniture, mismatched
    - Photos of family on walls
    - Thin walls (can hear neighbors)
    - Iron fire escape where they sit sometimes
    - Affordable rent (what they can manage)
    - Feels like home despite the chaos outside
- **Amp**
    - Small chaotic apartment in The Crossroads
    - 1-bedroom, barely furnished
    - Messy, unpaid bills stacked everywhere
    - Evidence of addiction: empty bottles, pills, scattered chaos
    - Sound system too powerful for the space (neighbors complain constantly)
    - Barely sleeps there (mostly at The Gilt)
    - Behind on rent (debt to casino keeps him trapped)
    - Eviction notices on the door
    - Dark even during day (curtains closed)
    - Ashtrays, takeout containers
    - Mattress on floor, no bed frame
    - Broken promises to Ledger everywhere

The Vibe:

- **Before Capital:** Chaotic but community support, working-class solidarity, neighbors helping neighbors, busy but manageable, corner stores where owners knew everyone, kids playing in streets (supervised), community pride despite struggles, hustle with heart
- **After Capital:** Survival mode, overwhelming chaos too much to handle, community fractured and isolated, noise unbearable (Gilt traffic added to existing chaos), everyone rushing (working multiple jobs to survive), corner stores closing (can't compete with casino economy), kids unsupervised (parents working constantly), anxiety and stress everywhere, static in the air

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4. THE MARGINS (West/South Borough)

Overarching Theme: Edges, Transition, Liminality, Hiding, Creation

What It Represents: The in-between spaces of Mo Town - where city meets nature, where old industry becomes art, where people hide or create, where things are unfinished or transforming, where those who don't fit elsewhere find space.

Key Areas:

Trailhead (City-to-Nature Transition)

- **Location:** Western/southwestern edge where Mo Town meets wilderness
- **Characteristics:**
    - Edge of city where buildings give way to parks and woods
    - Adventure zones, hiking trails, campgrounds
    - Mix of urban and natural (trees growing through old structures)
    - Less developed, more wild
    - Trailhead Lodge - Boy Scout meeting hall (rustic building, campfire circles)
    - Nature centers, environmental education
    - Adventure playground (rope courses, climbing walls, natural play)
    - Trails leading out of city into forest
    - Exploration spaces for kids
    - Camping areas, overnight spots
    - Less populated, room to breathe
    - Where city noise fades to birdsong

The Canvas (Old Industrial/Arts District)

- **Location:** Southern part of Margins, former industrial zone
- **Name Origin:** Blank canvas for artists to create
- **Characteristics:**
    - Abandoned warehouses and factories (brick, high ceilings)
    - Art studios in converted spaces (some abandoned, some active)
    - Alleyways covered in graffiti (Shade's work everywhere)
    - Dark corners, hidden spaces, shadows
    - Street art on every surface
    - Dim lighting, some streetlights broken
    - Underground culture, alternative spaces
    - Music venues in basements
    - Tattoo shops, vintage stores, coffee shops
    - Artists living/working in same spaces
    - Cheap rent attracting creatives
    - Raw, unfinished aesthetic
    - Warehouse raves, secret shows
    - Mix of legal and squatter spaces

Edgewood (Transitional Zone)

- **Location:** Far edge of The Margins, where Mo Town ends

- **Characteristics:**
    - Where city officially ends and nature begins (edge of the woods)
    - Cheaper housing: trailer parks, small houses in disrepair
    - Abandoned buildings waiting for development
    - Places people go to disappear
    - Unfinished developments (started then abandoned)
    - The forgotten edges nobody thinks about
    - Overgrown lots, nature reclaiming space
    - Loose zoning, anything goes
    - Off the grid feeling
    - Where Shade and Guess officially live (but we never see them there)

Housing in The Margins:

Residents:

- **Flo and Sputter**
    - Converted warehouse loft in The Canvas
    - Open floor plan, high ceilings (industrial bones)
    - Flo's dance area: mirrors, barre, sound system, open space
    - Sputter's workshop area: tools, robot parts, projects everywhere (half-finished)
    - Living space: cozy despite size, hanging fabric to section areas
    - Brick walls, exposed pipes and beams
    - Large windows (old factory windows)
    - Affordable rent (why they can have so much space)
    - Creative chaos, both sisters' aesthetics mixed
    - Kitchen area (Flo cooks, Sputter makes messes)
    - Sputter's room sectioned off (still messy)
    - Flo's room sectioned off (graceful, organized)
    - Feels alive, creative, full of motion
- **Shade**
    - Crashes in abandoned warehouse in The Canvas
    - NOT their official home (that's in Edgewood with Guess)
    - Come and go through broken window
    - Sleeping bag, minimal possessions
    - Walls covered in graffiti (their own work, constantly adding)
    - Art supplies scattered
    - Dark, hidden, safe feeling
    - Can hear the city but separated from it
    - No permanent setup (can leave anytime)
    - Multiple exit routes planned
    - Where Velour finds them and makes "comfortable"
- **Glitch**
    - Hidden basement apartment in abandoned building in Edgewood
    - Accessed through back alleys, hard to find
    - Deliberately obscure (doesn't want anyone to know where he lives)
    - Filled with monitors, tech equipment, wiring everywhere
    - Dark, flickering lights, unstable power
    - Server racks, computer parts
    - Can see Gilt security feeds from home (he set it up secretly)
    - Eats alone, surrounded by screens

    - Mattress in corner (barely sleeps)
    - Nobody knows where he lives except maybe Honeytrap
    - Cold, isolated, technological cave
    - Contrast to casino's sleek tech - this is jury-rigged, improvised
- **Shade and Guess**
    - Official home: small run-down house in Edgewood
    - OR possibly trailer in trailer park area
    - Technically they live here together as siblings
    - **But we never see them there**
    - The house/trailer exists but feels abandoned
    - Mail piles up outside
    - Lights rarely on
    - Neighbors never see them
    - Curtains drawn, door locked
    - Yard overgrown
    - Mystery: Do they actually live there? When are they there? Why are they never home?
    - Maybe they alternate? Maybe neither goes there?
    - It's a place that's theirs but they don't inhabit it

The Vibe:

- **Before Capital:** Creative freedom, safe exploration for kids at Trailhead, alternative spaces for artists, room to breathe and create, community of misfits and makers, abandoned spaces becoming art spaces, nature and urban in balance, affordable haven for those who don't fit elsewhere
- **After Capital:** More dangerous (less supervision, more desperate people), less supervised at Trailhead (adults working multiple jobs), some areas closed for casino development (Capital buying land for expansion), Shade hides deeper (less safe to be visible), art becomes desperate messages instead of joy, more abandoned spaces (economy struggling), more people pushed to margins (can't afford other boroughs), nature vs. development tension

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5. THE CAMPUS (North Edge - Technically Outside City Limits)

Overarching Theme: Learning, Growth, Exploration, Youth, Becoming

What It Represents: Where young people discover themselves, where knowledge is pursued, where futures are imagined - both hopeful and uncertain, where becoming happens, where you figure out who you are.

Key Areas:

Mo Town University (Mo U) - Main Campus

- **Location:** North edge, technically outside Mo Town city limits but connected

- **Characteristics:**
    - College campus (quads, pathways, green spaces)
    - Mix of old and new architecture
    - Older buildings: teal brick, traditional collegiate, ivy-covered
    - Newer buildings: glass, modern, tech-forward
    - Large windows, natural light
    - Libraries (main library, subject libraries)
    - Student center (food court, meeting rooms, lounges)
    - Dorms (traditional and suite-style)
    - Campus bookstore
    - Coffee shops (student-run and chain)
    - Quads where students gather, study, throw frisbees
    - Bike paths, pedestrian-only areas
    - Student life energy, always people around
    - Posters for events everywhere
    - Mix of serious academics and party culture

The Conservatory (Music Quarter)

- **Location:** Western side of campus
- **Characteristics:**
    - Music department buildings (sound-proofed)
    - Practice rooms (small soundproof boxes, students visible through windows)
    - Concert halls (various sizes)
    - Recording studios (professional equipment)
    - Instruments everywhere (students carrying cases)
    - Sound constantly (muffled practice, performances, rehearsals)
    - Recital halls, performance spaces
    - Music library (scores, recordings, research)
    - Collaboration spaces
    - Echo attends here, always practicing, searching for his sound
    - Posters for concerts, recitals, open mics
    - Creative energy mixed with pressure

Mo Sound Radio & Media Hub

- **Location:** Eastern side of campus, visible from road
- **Characteristics:**
    - Mo Sound Radio station - can see into broadcast booth from outside
    - Student newspaper offices: The Mo U Chronicle
    - Film/media production spaces (editing bays, equipment checkout)
    - Communication studies classrooms
    - Broadcast studios
    - Podcasting rooms
    - Media lab with computers
    - Always lights on (24/7 operations)
    - Student work displayed
    - Mo Sound Radio signal broadcasts across campus and into Mo Town
    - Resonate's late-night show originates here

The Innovation Sector

- **Location:** Southern edge of campus
- **Characteristics:**
    - Engineering buildings (modern, glass, tech aesthetic)
    - Tech labs, maker spaces
    - Robotics facilities (where competitions happen - Gilt sponsored)
    - 3D printers, laser cutters, tools
    - Research facilities
    - Computer science labs
    - Sputter comes here for robotics club/competitions
    - Corporate partnerships (including The Gilt)
    - Startup incubator spaces
    - Mix of academic and commercial

Off-Campus Housing Area

- **Location:** Surrounding the campus, within walking/biking distance
- **Characteristics:**
    - Student apartment complexes
    - Houses divided into student rentals
    - Cheaper than dorms, more independence
    - Coffee shops, cheap restaurants, bars
    - Laundromats, convenience stores
    - Student-oriented businesses
    - More freedom, less supervision
    - Where Resonate lives

Housing on/near The Campus:

Residents:

- **Echo**
    - Student housing/dorms on Mo U campus
    - Likely traditional dorm: small room, roommate, shared bathroom down hall
    - OR suite-style: small bedroom, shared common area with suitemates
    - Minimal space, just enough
    - Instruments everywhere (guitar, keyboard, whatever he's trying)
    - Music posters, but they're of OTHER artists (nothing of his own yet)
    - Notebooks with lyrics/music (all derivative)
    - Headphones always nearby
    - Bed, desk, small closet
    - Practice room time scheduled at The Conservatory
    - Student meal plan
    - Surrounded by other students but feels alone
    - Window overlooks campus
- **Resonate**
    - Off-campus apartment near Mo U (walking distance to Mo Sound Radio)
    - Shares with a roommate (not one of The Motions - regular Mo U student)
    - 2-bedroom apartment, affordable student housing
    - Her room: covered in posters (esoteric, conspiracy, art, music)
    - Records, CDs, music collection
    - Radio equipment for practicing/recording

    - Microphone setup, sound mixing board
    - Dark curtains (sleeps during day, works late night show)
    - Incense, crystals, spiritual items
    - Books on conspiracy theories, occult, philosophy
    - More independent than dorms
    - Can walk/bike to Mo Sound Radio
    - Kitchen shared with roommate
    - Living room with mismatched furniture
    - Feels like her own space, her identity

The Vibe:

- **Before Capital:** Exploration and finding yourself, creative freedom without commercial pressure, community of learners supporting each other, hope for the future and possibilities, safe space to try and fail and grow, affordable education, professors who care, focus on learning not money, idealism alive
- **After Capital:** The Gilt recruits students for work (promises of money, fast cash), pressure to be commercial (what sells vs. what matters), some students dropping out for casino jobs (quick money over education), student debt and financial stress intensifying, Gilt-sponsored programs and competitions (strings attached), futures feel uncertain (will education pay off?), corporate influence creeping in, idealism struggling against pragmatism, Echo and Resonate both feeling the pressure

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CONNECTING FEATURES ACROSS BOROUGHS:

The Waterways:

Clearwater Creek

- Runs through The Heights (Streamside neighborhood)
- Peaceful, clean water
- Small bridges, meditation spots along the banks
- Flows down from hills
- Gardens along the water
- Harbor's Tranquil Tides is near here
- **Before Capital:** Clean, flowing, life-giving, people meditate by it, kids play safely
- **After Capital:** Still cleaner than other water, but casino runoff starting to affect it upstream

Ironside Canal

- Runs through The Lower Wards
- More industrial, faster-moving
- Used for commerce, delivery routes follow it
- Concrete banks in places
- **Before Capital:** Working water, still clean enough, neighborhood kids fish
- **After Capital:** Polluted by casino runoff, trash accumulating, smell worse

The Vein

- Connects the streams through The Heart
- Used to run through Community Center (the fountain)
- Central water feature of Mo Town
- Carries life through the heart (hence the name)
- **Before Capital:** Beautiful, clear, the heart's circulation, fountain in Community Center was fed by this
- **After Capital:** Disrupted by Gilt construction, fountain broken and dry, flow redirected underground for casino plumbing

All Waterways:

- Connect the boroughs (can follow water from Heights to Lower Wards to Heart)
- **Before Capital:** Clean, flowing, life-giving, connecting feature, health of the city
- **After Capital:** Polluted by casino runoff and development, flow disrupted, connection broken

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The Transit System:

The Pulse Line

- Connects all boroughs to The Heart (downtown)
- Most frequent service
- Hub at Union Terminal (central terminal)
- **Before Capital:** Efficient, on-time, affordable, connects everyone
- **After Capital:** Delays, crowded, service cuts to save money, Gilt ads everywhere

The Ascent Line

- Runs up to The Heights (literal incline, hence the name)
- Connects Streamside area to Overlook District to The Summit area
- Expensive neighborhoods, less frequent service
- **Before Capital:** Clean, quiet, serves all income levels in Heights
- **After Capital:** Prioritizes Overlook District, cuts to affordable areas

The Circle Line

- Circles The Lower Wards (hence the name)

- Most heavily used (working people commuting)
- Constant service, always crowded
- **Before Capital:** Frequent, reliable, lifeline for workers
- **After Capital:** Overcrowded (casino workers added), delays constant, breakdowns

The Outbound Line

- Connects to The Margins and The Campus
- Less frequent (lower population density)
- Scenic route (nature views)
- **Before Capital:** Peaceful, students and artists use it, affordable
- **After Capital:** Service cuts, some stops eliminated, less reliable

Union Terminal (Central Hub)

- Located in The Heart (downtown)
- Where all lines connect
- Transfer point between boroughs
- **Physical space:**
    - Large terminal building
    - Platforms for different lines
    - Departure/arrival boards
    - Waiting areas with benches
    - Shops, food vendors
    - Information desk
    - Always people coming and going
    - Represents transit, movement, connection and disconnection
- **Before Capital:** Busy but organized, people meeting up, excitement of connection, community gathering point
- **After Capital:** More chaotic, people leaving Mo Town (departures outnumber arrivals), advertisements overwhelming, Gilt recruitment posters, fewer people arriving, sense of loss

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The Roads:

Summit Boulevard

- Main road through The Heights
- Wide, tree-lined, well-maintained
- Connects Overlook District to Streamside to The Summit
- Overlooks with views of city below
- **Before Capital:** Beautiful drive, access to elevation for all
- **After Capital:** Still nice but more exclusive feeling, less welcoming

The Crossroads Streets

- Network of narrow streets through Lower Wards (collective term for the chaotic network - no single name)
- Delivery routes, always traffic
- Quake's delivery routes go through here constantly
- One-way streets, confusing intersections
- **Before Capital:** Busy but navigable, community knew the patterns
- **After Capital:** Gridlock, Gilt deliveries added, honking constant, chaos unbearable

Canvas Alleys

- Dark, narrow paths through The Margins (collective term - "Canvas alleys" or "back alleys")
- Connect abandoned buildings, cut-throughs
- Where Shade leaves their graffiti
- Not official roads, just paths between things
- **Before Capital:** Artists use them, safe enough, community presence
- **After Capital:** Darker, more dangerous, less people around, Shade goes deeper

University Avenue

- Main road from The Heart to The Campus
- Well-lit, designed for students walking/biking
- Connects city to university
- **Before Capital:** Safe, students always walking, community connection
- **After Capital:** More cars (students can't afford to live on campus), less walking, Gilt recruiting along the route

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The Sky:

The View From Everywhere:

- Sky always has teal tint over all boroughs
- **Before Capital:** Clear, bright teal - same hopeful color across all boroughs, unified
- **After Capital:** Darker teal, corrupted by neon orange/gold from The Gilt (visible from all boroughs), casino looms in skyline from everywhere, can't escape seeing it, neon pollution even at night, unified in corruption now instead of hope

The Mo Town Sign:

- Large letters on hillside in The Heights (like Hollywood sign)
- Teal letters, iconic landmark
- Visible from all boroughs on clear days
- **Before Capital:** Symbol of pride, hope, identity, "this is our city"
- **After Capital:** Capital's mansion looms above it (dominates the symbol), represents how power/wealth are above the people, corrupted landmark

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BOROUGH CONNECTIONS & ISOLATION:

Before Capital:

- Boroughs connected by community, shared spaces, transit
- People moved between boroughs freely (work in one, live in another, play in another)
- The Heart was gathering place for all boroughs
- Community Center hosted people from everywhere
- The Vein and waterways flowed between boroughs (connection)
- Transit was affordable and reliable (connection)
- Shared identity as Mo Town residents
- Borders between boroughs were soft, permeable

After Capital:

- Boroughs becoming isolated from each other
- People stay in their own areas more (too expensive/exhausting to travel)
- The Heart is corrupted (people avoid it)
- No Community Center to gather everyone
- Waterways are polluted (broken connection)
- Transit is expensive and unreliable (broken connection)
- Identity fracturing (Heights vs. Lower Wards, us vs. them)
- Borders between boroughs hardening, class divisions visible
- The Gilt visible from everywhere but most people only interact with it in The Heart
- The Motions scattered across boroughs, harder to support each other

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HOUSING BY BOROUGH:

THE HEIGHTS:

- Capital - Cliffside mansion above Mo Town sign
- Harbor, North, Bossy Boots - Multi-generational home in Streamside
- Polish - Penthouse in Overlook District (Pilot & Pinch live here during week)
- Frame - Structured townhome in Overlook District
- Drift - Small apartment in Hillcrest (barely affordable)

THE HEART:

- Plenty - Loft above Plenty & Sons Construction Co. (Pilot & Pinch visit weekends)
- Ledger - Apartment near Analytics Central
- Signal - Lives with/near Ledger
- Honeytrap - Luxury penthouse near The Gilt
- Velour - Luxury condo (same building as Honeytrap, one floor below)
- Mirrorball - Flashy loft in downtown

THE LOWER WARDS:

- Quake & Static - Family apartment in Ironside
- Amp - Chaotic apartment in The Crossroads (behind on rent, in debt)

THE MARGINS:

- Flo & Sputter - Converted warehouse loft in The Canvas
- Shade - Crashes in abandoned warehouse in The Canvas (official home in Edgewood with Guess, never seen there)
- Glitch - Hidden basement apartment in Edgewood (nobody knows location)
- Shade & Guess - Official home in Edgewood (but never seen there)

THE CAMPUS:

- Echo - Student housing/dorms at Mo U
- Resonate - Off-campus apartment with roommate near Mo U